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Curriculum Vitae
Fall 2026

Johanna Torres Chain

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Citizenship: Colombia, F-1 visa

Major Fields of Concentration

Macroeconomics; Public Economics; Household Finance; Labor Economics

Education

Degree	Field	Institution	Year
PhD	Economics	University of Minnesota (expected)	2027
MA	Economics	University of Minnesota	2024
MA	Economics	Universidad Alberto Hurtado, Chile / Georgetown University	2017
BA	Economics	Universidad del Norte, Colombia	2015

Dissertation

Title: "The Value of Family Care: Couples, Singles, and Medicaid in Old Age"
Dissertation Advisor(s): Professor Mariacristina De Nardi
Expected Completion: Summer 2027

References

Reference Name	Email / Contact Info	Address
Professor Mariacristina De Nardi	denar001@umn.edu (612) 624-1978	Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, 4-101 Hanson Hall, Minneapolis, Minnesota 55455
Professor Joseph Mullins	mullinsj@umn.edu (612) 625-7858	Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, 4-101 Hanson Hall, Minneapolis, Minnesota 55455
Dr. Alessandra Fogli	afogli00@gmail.com (612) 204-5485	Research Department, Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, 90 Hennepin Avenue, Minneapolis, Minnesota 55401

Honors and Awards

2025–2026	*Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship*, National Bureau of Economic Research, supported by the Alfred P. Sloan Foundation
2026	*Best Poster Award*, Embrace Day Graduate Posters Session, Canadian Economics Association Annual Meetings, Vancouver, Canada
2025	*Conference Travel Grant*, Council of Graduate Students, University of Minnesota
2024	*Funding Award*, Health and Retirement Study Summer Workshop, University of Michigan
2023	*Distinguished Teaching Assistant*, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota
2022	*Summer Graduate Fellowship*, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota
2017	*Magna Cum Laude M.A. Graduation*, Universidad Alberto Hurtado
2016–2017	*Full Scholarship for Graduate Studies in Economics*, Georgetown University/ILADES
2015	*Honorable Mention—Best University Student*, Premios Portafolio, Colombia
2015	*Silver Medal for Academic Excellence*, Universidad del Norte, Colombia
2015	*Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis*, Universidad del Norte, Colombia

Research Experience

2023–Present	*Research Assistant* for Mariacristina De Nardi, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota.
2018	*Research Fellow*, Inter-American Development Bank, Washington, DC. Worked with Andrés Fernández (IMF), Laura Alfaro (IDB and Harvard Business School), and Miguel Acosta (Central Bank of Chile).

Professional Experience

2019–2021	*Economic Advisor*, Central Bank of Chile. Part-time advisor to Board Member Pablo García Silva.
2018–2021	*Junior Economist*, Macroeconomic Analysis Department, Central Bank of Chile. Modeling and forecasting for the Monetary Policy Report.

Teaching Experience

Summer 2023	*Instructor* (Writing Sections) for Economic Development (Undergraduate), Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota.
2022–2023	*Teaching Assistant* for Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate), Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota.
2020	*Teaching Assistant* for Macroeconomics II (Graduate), Universidad Alberto Hurtado, Santiago, Chile.
2017	*Teaching Assistant* for Econometrics II (Graduate), Universidad Alberto Hurtado, Santiago, Chile.

Working Papers

Torres Chain, Johanna. "The Value of Family Care: Couples, Singles, and Medicaid in Old Age"**(Job Market Paper)**

Presented by me: Canadian Public Economics Group Annual Meeting (Montréal, 2026); Inter-American Development Bank Research Conference (Washington, DC, 2026); Canadian Economics Association Annual Meeting (Vancouver, 2026); Women in Macroeconomics Conference (Chicago, 2026); HHEI Alumni Conference (2026).

Torres Chain, Johanna. "The Family as Insurer: Race, Long-Term Care, and Wealth After Retirement"

Bullano, Francisco; Torres Chain, Johanna. "The Incidence of Health Risk: Home Production, Self-Insurance, and Who Bears the Cost"

Borella, Margherita; De Nardi, Mariacristina; Torres Chain, Johanna; Yang, Fang. "Why do (most) households save and work?" (Revise and resubmit at the *American Economic Review*)

Presented by me: Canadian Economics Association Annual Meeting (Vancouver, 2026); European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society (Nicosia, Cyprus, 2025); Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting (Cleveland, 2025).

Work in Progress

Conti, Gabriella; De Nardi, Mariacristina; Giustinelli, Pamela; Torres Chain, Johanna; Wang, Fan. "How is Health Produced? Estimating Subjective Health Production Functions"

Referee Experience

Review of Economic Dynamics

Computer Skills

MATLAB, Stata, Fortran, R, EViews, Dynare Toolkit, LaTeX, Qualtrics, LimeSurvey

Languages

Spanish (native), English (fluent)

Abstract(s)

Torres Chain, Johanna. "The Value of Family Care: Couples, Singles, and Medicaid in Old Age"**(Job Market Paper)**
I study the value of family care to older households and how it affects their gains from an expansion of Medicaid. Using Health and Retirement Study data, I estimate a life-cycle model of retired couples and singles that distinguishes spousal care from care provided by children, other relatives, and friends. To remain as well off as with continued family care, households would need a one-time payment averaging $58,719 (in 2018 dollars) when all family care is removed for the rest of their lives. For couples, the average compensation needed for a 50 percent reduction in care from children and others is 42 percent lower when spousal care is available than when it is absent. To assess the consequences of declining family support, I consider a scenario based on demographic projections for 2060 in which total family-care hours fall by 37.7 percent. Households buy more paid care, receive less care overall, and reduce consumption and saving, while Medicaid transfers change little. Existing family care also reduces households' gains from more generous Medicaid support.

Torres Chain, Johanna. "The Family as Insurer: Race, Long-Term Care, and Wealth After Retirement"
I study how family care and existing public support shape racial differences in retirement wealth and the gains from additional long-term-care insurance. Using Health and Retirement Study data, I estimate a saving model of White and Black single women aged 70 or older. Starting wealth and income account for 65–90 percent of the simulated wealth gap at ages 74–84. With family care and nursing-home risk held fixed, a subsidy covering half of nursing-home expenses yields average wealth-equivalent gains of $92,000 for White retirees and $13,000 for Black retirees in the middle third of each race's income distribution (2018 dollars). The subsidy protects resources retirees would otherwise spend, but provides less additional insurance when existing means-tested support already covers the expense. Its value therefore depends on retirees' own resources, family help, and the public coverage already in place.

Borella, Margherita; De Nardi, Mariacristina; Torres Chain, Johanna; Yang, Fang. "Why do (most) households save and work?" (Revise and resubmit at the *American Economic Review*)

We quantify why most households save and work, using a life-cycle model with wage risk, endogenous labor supply of both spouses, marital transitions, health, medical expenses, mortality, and bequest motives at the death of the first and last household member, estimated on PSID and HRS data. A model with more motives to save and endogenous labor supply implies smaller roles for precautionary saving against wage risk and for bequest motives than previously suggested. Modeling the entire life cycle implies a larger role for medical expenses, because households save and work for them long before they retire. Marriage and divorce risk has large and offsetting effects on the savings of couples and singles, and thus small effects on aggregate savings, but affects aggregate earnings as much as wage risk.